— issue 008 —

The Morning Oracle

ONE COFFEE · PRICE · MORNING EDITION · 008

✦ WHAT TOMORROW HOLDS, READ THIS MORNING ✦

MORNING EDITION
Wednesday, October 7, 2026
FOUR COLUMNS · TWO PAGES

FIGURE OF THE DAY

84.4%

of Chewy's sales come from Autoship, its scheduled deliveries (p. 2).

WORD OF THE DAY

Recurring revenue

n. — definition on page 2.

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☞ FRONT PAGE · AI

ANTHROPIC OPENS UP ON CYBER

Three access tiers: the more you prove your trade, the less the model refuses.

EXCLUSIVE

On October 6, Anthropic merged two initiatives, Project Glasswing and the Cyber Verification Program, into a single expanded program. The principle: verified professionals get models with lighter safeguards.

Three tiers. "Defense" covers incident response, malware reverse engineering and vulnerability analysis; many defensive organizations should qualify, with a response targeted within a few days. "Red team" adds authorized penetration testing, for organizations only, with weeks of review. "Specialized" (aviation, power grids, telecoms, banking) is reviewed with the US government.

Models covered: Claude Opus 5.5, Sonnet 5.5 and Mythos 5.1. Glasswing helped its partners find at least 129,000 verified vulnerabilities (April–July 2026).

For a developer testing their own products: a model that refused yesterday may answer tomorrow, once you're recognized.

TECH IN BRIEF

COPILOT: THE USAGE STATISTICS WERE LYING

Copilot metrics showed agent activity falling while usage was rising: sessions run through the SDK didn't report their editor.

Fix: VS Code 1.139.0 or later. Billing unaffected; missing data not backfilled.

THE LAB ANSWERS

The riddle

I come back without being called, I never knock on the door, and you stop seeing me once you forget me. What am I?

Answer: the direct debit or the scheduled delivery (p. 2)

THE QUOTE

"Less, but better": the tenth principle of good design.

— *Dieter Rams*

TODAY'S PET PEEVE

HOW LONG WILL THIS APPLIANCE LAST?

Two washing machines at the same price, no idea which one will last ten years.

In the store, the selling points are power, capacity, color. Lifespan isn't shown. In France, a durability index, scored out of 10, tries to fill that gap: it has existed for TVs since January 8, 2025 and for washing machines since April 8, 2025.

It weighs the availability and price of spare parts, ease of disassembly, and resistance to stress and wear. Other products (laptops, dishwashers, vacuums…) keep the repairability index: two scores to juggle.

BUSINESS LEAD

A "ten-year cost" comparison tool: scan the barcode, see the durability or repairability score, the price of common parts and the warranty length, then the real cost per year of use. Competition: consumer tests exist, but not at the moment of purchase.

THE BUSINESS MODEL

CHEWY: 84% OF SALES ON SUBSCRIPTION

A bag of kibble comes back every month. Might as well have the delivery come back too.

Chewy sells pet food and supplies online. Its Autoship service schedules deliveries at a fixed interval: the customer no longer reorders, they only change or cancel.

In the first quarter of its fiscal 2026 (ended May 3, 2026), Autoship accounted for $2.833 billion, or 84.4% of net sales, up from 82.2% a year earlier. Autoship sales grew 10.5%, while total net sales ($3.357 billion) rose 7.7%.

The result: predictable demand, 21.5 million active customers (+3.6%), a 30.1% gross margin (+0.5 points) and net income of $94.8 million.

TAKEAWAY

A consumable product, a known rhythm, renewal by default: recurrence sells best on what customers would buy again anyway.

PET PEEVE IN BRIEF

THE FIRST PACKAGE, PUBLISHED BY HAND

Until now, creating a new npm package required a first manual publish before you could automate the rest. On October 2, npm lifted that constraint: the first version of a new package goes through a queue where a maintainer approves it.

The lead: already solved by npm. Which "manual just once" step is still blocking your automations?

DESIGN & UX

WHEN THE ASSISTANT BECOMES A BALL OF MUD

The Nielsen Norman Group watches people tinker with AI automations until they no longer know how they hold together.

In a study published October 2, Tanner Kohler describes non-technical users who evolve their AI tools bit by bit. A daily summary of emails and tasks grows until it becomes unmanageable: one participant says they are "stuck with the way it works".

Another case: an Asana widget that, in three steps, became a cross-team dashboard with weighted algorithms. Another participant let the AI save their files at the root of their Drive. A last one, with a "to summarize" folder, saw the AI fetch the wrong articles: 45 minutes lost fixing their instructions.

The group suggests distinguishing three contexts: global (valid everywhere), local (specific to a task) and ambient (streams of information), naming the one you're changing, periodically reviewing the global context and refreshing the local one when results degrade.

TAKEAWAY

When your users build with your product, give them a way to see and name what they've built: a list of their instructions, their sources, what changed.

TECH

STACKED PULL REQUESTS FOR EVERYONE

On October 6, GitHub declared "stacked pull requests" generally available, more than two months after the public preview of July 30. The idea: split a big change into an ordered series of small pull requests, reviewed separately.

The final version keeps approvals and signed commits through a rebase, automatically retargets branches when a base is deleted, and auto-merge arrives in the following weeks. You move between pull requests with Shift+J and Shift+K, and the *gh stack* extension handles worktrees. Available on all github.com plans; GitHub Enterprise Server will follow.

BUSINESS ANGLE

Small pull requests are quick to review: review and stack-tracking tools are about to become a niche market.

THE WORD

Recurring revenue, *n.* : Money that comes back at regular intervals without a new sale: subscriptions, scheduled deliveries, maintenance. At Chewy, Autoship scheduled delivery accounts for 84.4% of it (p. 2). The upside: you can plan your stock and your months.

READER'S NOTEBOOK — SOMETHING THAT BUGGED YOU TODAY, AN IDEA:

The Morning Oracle — morning paper written and typeset by Claude for 1977 Éditions, from an idea by Michael Misran.
Sources: anthropic.com · sec.gov · github.blog · nngroup.com · ecologie.gouv.fr · vitsoe.com